Participant Information and Consent Form

Development of Haptic Wearable Devices for Morse Code Communication

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Course: EEE4022S

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1. What is this study about?

You are invited to take part in a short study testing a wearable device that communicates using vibration. The device is worn on the wrist. A user taps a message on one device, and a second device reproduces that message as a pattern of vibrations, using Morse code. The purpose of this study is to find out how accurately a person can feel and interpret these vibrations, and how easy the device is to use. This information will help improve the design of the device.

Please read this form carefully before deciding whether to take part. You may ask the researcher any questions at any time.

2. What will you be asked to do?

If you agree to take part, you will be asked to:

- wear the device on your wrist;
- feel a series of vibration patterns and indicate when you detect them;
- after a short explanation of the code, identify a small set of simple characters delivered as vibration;
- tap a few short inputs on the device; and
- complete a brief questionnaire at the end about how comfortable and easy to use you found the device.

The session takes place in a quiet room and will last less than 30 minutes in total. No audio or video recordings will be made at any point.

3. Are there any risks?

The risks are minimal. The device produces gentle, low-intensity vibration, similar to that of a smartphone or smartwatch. It runs on a small rechargeable battery and is not connected to mains electricity. The vibration is set to a comfortable level, and you may ask for it to be reduced or stopped at any time. There are no known health risks associated with taking part.

4. Will any of your personal information be recorded?

No. No personal information will be collected or recorded at any stage of this study — not even your name. Please do not write your name anywhere on this form or on the questionnaire.

The only information recorded is how accurately and quickly the tasks are completed, and your answers to the questionnaire. None of this can be linked back to you. Signed consent forms are stored separately from the research data, and there is no code, number or other marker connecting this form to the results of your session.

5. Is participation voluntary?

Yes. Taking part is entirely voluntary and unpaid. You may stop and withdraw at any time, for any reason or for no reason at all, simply by telling the researcher. You do not have to explain why, and there will be no penalty or negative consequence of any kind. You may also decline to answer any question on the questionnaire.

Please note that because the data is completely anonymous and cannot be linked to you, it will not be possible to identify and remove your results once your session has finished and your questionnaire has been submitted.

6. What happens to the results?

The anonymous results will be analysed and reported in the student researcher's final year thesis, and may be used in related academic outputs. Because no personal information is collected, no participant can be identified in any report.

7. Who can you contact?

If you have any questions about this study, please contact the student researcher at khnmah014@myuct.ac.za.

Declaration by the participant

Please read each statement and tick the box to confirm that you agree.

☑ I have read and understood the information provided above.

☑ I have had the opportunity to ask questions, and any questions I had were answered.

☑ I understand that my participation is voluntary, and that I may stop at any time without giving a reason and without any penalty.

☑ I understand that no personal information, including my name, will be recorded, and that my results cannot be linked back to me.

☑ I understand that I will be asked to complete a short questionnaire at the end of the session, and that I may decline to answer any question.

☑ I understand that the anonymous results may be used in the researcher's thesis and related academic outputs.

☑ I agree to take part in this study.

Please do not write your name on this form. Your signature below is not stored with, or linked to, any of the data collected.

Signature of participant:  Date: 24/10/2026

Signature of researcher: _____ Date: _____

A copy of this form is available for you to keep.